

Ohio River Water Trail Map & Guide Preparation Request for Proposal

Submitted: October 11, 2012

Environmental Planning and Design, LLC

*Andrew JG Schwartz, AICP, RLA, LEED® AP
Managing Principal*

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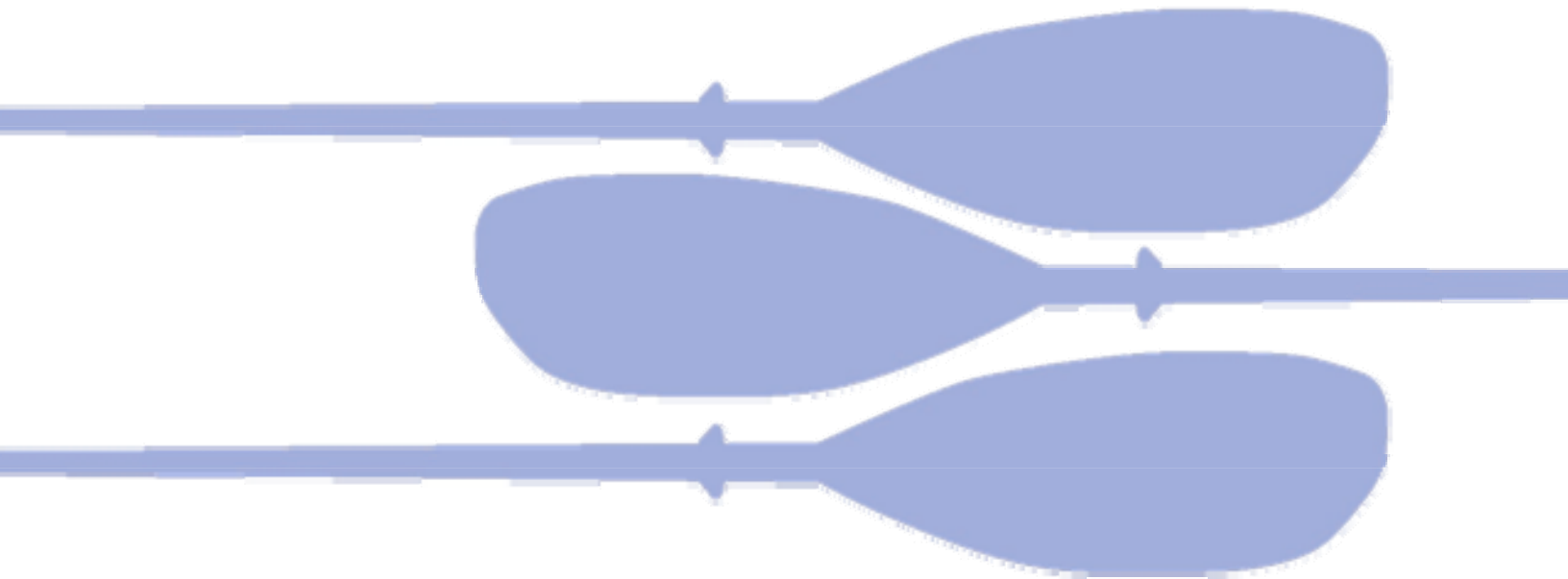
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Ohio River Water Trail Map & Guide Preparation

TABLE OF CONTENTS

TAB

Cover Letter

EPD's Water Trail Philosophy

Work Approach & Cost Breakdown..... 1

Work Approach

Work Schedule

Cost Estimate

Hourly Rates

Statement of Qualifications..... 2

Firm Overview

Related Projects

Key Personnel Resumes

Project Team Summary - List of Subcontractors..... 3

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EPD

ENVIRONMENTAL
PLANNING & DESIGN, LLC

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Community Planners
Urban Designers

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October 9, 2012

Dr. Vince Troia, CEO
Ohio River Trail Council
1100 Pennsylvania Avenue
Monaca, PA 15061

Dear Dr. Troia:

We are pleased to submit the following proposal to Ohio River Trail Council (ORTC) to prepare the Ohio River Water Trail Map and Guide. We have formed a Team with extensive professional and practical experience in the project area and all of the RFP's defined tasks and with established relationships collaborating with several of the Ohio River Water Trail Committee Partners and Affiliated Organizations.

Our Team, a collaboration of Environmental Planning and Design (EPD) and blue tomato design, offers unparalleled GIS expertise relevant to this corridor and the greater Southwestern Pennsylvania region as well as extensive experience in the creation of both logos and map/text-based publications for our clients.

Environmental Planning and Design, LLC, (EPD), with national recognition in community planning and design brings seven decades of recreation systems analysis, programming, community work and design to the table. From data evaluation to implementation, EPD provides a strong background in project prioritization and design expertise.

blue tomato design, a Pittsburgh-based graphic design firm will function as the Team's expert in web-design and print-based communications. From logos to graphics, blue tomato's portfolio boasts a wide range of work known both for its sophisticated creativity and functionality.

Principals	Jack R. Scholl	Andrew JG Schwartz	Susan M. Simmers
Associates	Carolyn E. Yagle	Jonathan D. Stilan	
Emeritus	John Ormsbee Simonds (1913-2005)	Philip D. Simonds (1916-1995)	Paul Dorr Wolfe (1930-2000)

From our experience in the water and in the office, we recognize three fundamental issues important to this project's success:

1. **River and paddling understanding:** As river enthusiasts, we will be able to quickly and accurately do site reconnaissance and field checking of data. As planners, designers and outdoor enthusiasts, we are excited about this project.
2. **Rivertown knowledge:** Many of our clients call these riverbanks home. We understand features along the river and community patterns as well as policy issues impacting the river because of direct involvement with communities adjacent to the Ohio River on issues like land use, riverfront policy discussions and goals. EPD has worked directly in communities along 63-mile project corridor such as Beaver, Neville Island, and Sewickley. We bring knowledge of these communities to this project.
3. **GIS data:** As participants and lead consultants in a number of mapping projects in the region, including the Power of 32 Trail Mapping and GIS Database, we possess a GIS database holding nearly all of the information needed to complete this project.
4. **Graphic design experience:** As a team, we have created organization-directed logos, documents, maps and brochures that communicate necessary information through visual cues and text and we are ready to bring our momentum to this project.

If our Team is selected, I will be Principal-in-Charge and will provide continual project oversight as well as focus on park and facility design issues. Carolyn Yagle, RLA, AICP an Associate with our firm, will be Project Director responsible for coordinating day-to-day recreation and planning efforts. Carolyn will be the project's primary point of contact between the ORTC and the Team members. Both Carolyn and I are avid paddlers and we were fortunate to be part the early workshops that Pennsylvania Environmental Council facilitated to plan the initial stages of the Ohio River Watertrail.

The enclosed proposal represents our "first pass" at addressing the RFP requirements. We would be happy to discuss any opportunities to refine or customize our assumptions, proposed work scope and/or proposed fee estimate to best meet the needs of ORTC. As ORTC continues its mission to build better communities through the Ohio River Trail, we would enjoy the opportunity to assist with improving the water trail experience for all users through excellent mapping and trail guide production. Our project Team and our years of navigating this corridor have prepared us for fulfilling just such a role. We would enjoy working with you and look forward to getting out on the water soon.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in blue ink that reads "Andrew JG Schwartz". The signature is fluid and cursive, with a stylized "A" and "S".

Andrew JG Schwartz, RLA, AICP, LEED® AP
Managing Principal

Trail Planning Philosophy

EPD believes that there is a series of basic “building blocks” in trail planning and use that applies to both land and water trails. While the combination of these ingredients varies from place to place and from trail to trail, their presence is essential for the trail’s long-term success. With this philosophy, we’ve been able to create many miles of navigable and fulfilling recreation.



Safety

Use safety is the “first and final thought” in trail design. The location, alignment and sight lines of a trail, as well as appropriate safety devices establish the envelope for a water trail corridor.



Amenities

Amenities such as historic and cultural assets and land-side rest points enrich the trail experience.



Interest

People use trails that are engaging, informative or memorable. Unique natural features, plant and animal habitat/diversity, and cultural artifacts provide the basis for engaging trails.



Clarity

Routing a trail with clear, legible way-finding signage is essential for trail user comfort and long-term use.

“Paddle-ability”

Accessibility, clearance and sight lines affect the “paddle-ability” of a water trail and necessitate clear sight lines, spatial separation from obstacles and “rest areas.”



Public Engagement

Building awareness, consensus and “buy-in” among the community, public officials and stakeholders is essential to short and long-term water trail success.



Experience

To be an effective water trail planner, you need to be an avid water trail user.

Six Compelling Distinctions

We believe these attributes present several compelling distinctions of the EPD Team. We also believe these attributes will provide the Ohio River Trail Council with the effectiveness, efficiency and experience it desires to have as part of this project.

1. Our Team is composed of experience kayakers who *want* to be involved because water recreation and discovery is a passion.
2. Our Team has direct access to both a motor boat and kayaks, thus keeping direct expenses low and having equipment available at any time needed (no complexities with third-party coordination).
3. Our Team worked with PEC to compile the Power of 32 database and developed the online (“cloud”) GIS system. There is no need to spend time ramping up to understand how to integrate and/or use the data as part of this effort.
4. Our Team possesses a rich inventory (70%-100%) of other related, substantive GIS data required for this project. The river miles layer is the only one layer we would need to create or source from a third party.
5. Our Team includes experienced graphic artists and web designers that clients have noted for their energy and enthusiasm – not to mention their ability to inspire new lines of thinking and alternative in project deliverables.
6. Our Team proposes to deliver drafts of two of the three major work products prior to the end of November.

Work Approach

Organization

The Work Approach, Schedule, and Cost Summary all follow the same organization and numbering format for ease of reference and comparison. The organization of the Work Approach is generally based on the RFP and our professional experience. The Work Scope anticipates a 4 to 6-month completion based on options chosen by ORTC and meeting schedules.



Work Approach

Each of the major work tasks (indicated by the bold text) outlined below represent a major element or component of the overall effort to create a trail map and guide. In brief, these tasks entail the following:

- **Compile and Review Existing Information and Base Maps**
- **Prepare Base Maps for the Map and Guide**
- **Preparation of Water Trail Map and Guide**
- **Optional Publication of Map and Guide**

A. Compile and Review Existing Information and Base Maps

1. Compile and Review Existing Information (Scope: 2.1.1)

Based on the Scope of Services, the list of GIS map layers provided in Attachment B of the RFP, and an initial review of our existing GIS database, EPD holds a significant percentage of the requested GIS data. Based on ORTC’s specific requirements regarding certain information (i.e. the contour interval desired for digital elevation/topography), EPD will determine what additional information will be required from outside organizations.

EPD has worked extensively on planning and design projects in the region that have allowed us to build our GIS database and become familiar with the datasets needed for this type of project. For example, PEC’s Power of 32 Trail Map was completed by EPD.

GIS Layers Required	% in EPD Database
Major and minor roads	100%
Hydrography	100%
State, county and municipal boundaries	100%
Public Lands	80%
Existing and proposed land trails	80%
Digital Elevation *assuming 20’ contour intervals	100%
Public and private key access	70%
River miles	0%
Locks and Dams	100%
Bridges	100%
Railroads	100%
Historic and cultural sites of interest	70%

Deliverable: Initial draft base map, inset maps and index maps; outline of additional GIS layers required from outside organizations.



2. Review Relevant Plans and Studies (Scope: 2.1.3)

A review of past and current planning efforts related to the area of the water trail and map guide will allow us to understand where the river area is headed in the future. This background information will frame an analysis of how much emphasis should be placed on amenities, docking areas and other key points along the Ohio River because of their capacity to change in the future based on local planning efforts. This will help to ensure that the final map and trail guide will remain relevant to existing river and shore conditions for years to come.

Our Team assumes that ORTC will provide appropriate digital or hard copies of relevant planning documents related to trails and greenways for the region including county greenway and trail plans.

Deliverable: Outline of areas where changes may occur in the future.

3. Project Statement

Effective visual communication and graphic design starts with a clear project statement and goals. Following an assessment of the breadth and depth of the information to be included on the map and trail guide, EPD will work with ORTC and ORWTC to outline specific vision and goals for the map and trail guide. Together with our Team, ORTC and the ORWTC will consider the vision and goals for the trail map and guide. We anticipate reviewing existing ORTC maps and trail guides as well as publications from other organizations like the PA Fish and Boat Commission and nationally recognized water trail guides to evaluate effective means of communicating in light of the breadth and depth of existing data, new data to be added and area to be mapped.

Deliverable: Project statement and goals.



Work Approach

4. Compile and Review Additional Information and Base Maps (Scope: 2.1.1)

Based on our assessment of EPD's existing GIS databases and conversations regarding specific information to be included on the final trail map and guide, we will review and compile existing GIS base maps that are available from various affiliated organizations.

EPD will work with ORTC and ORWTC to gather all required GIS layers as outlined.

Deliverable: Preliminary base map, inset maps and index map.

5. Field Reconnaissance to Check All Data (Scope: 2.1.2)

Once all data has been compiled and reviewed, we will assess the corridor by motor boat and kayak identifying and verifying existing and potential access points as well as hazards and opportunities along the river to acquire additional GPS points as needed. As outdoor enthusiasts and avid boaters, our experience will allow us to quickly and accurately identify points that need to be noted on the water trail map and guide.

EPD assumes that two to three ORTC staff or volunteers will accompany one EPD staff member during the corridor assessment.

Deliverable: Preliminary base map to be used for field checking.



B. Prepare Base Maps for the Map and Guide

1. Prepare Base Maps for the Map and Guide (Scope: 2.2.1 to 2.2.6)

Once all information has been compiled and EPD has surveyed the Ohio River corridor by boat, mapping will be completed synthesizing all information into one base map with supplementary index maps, segment insets and additional information as determined by our Team, ORTC and ORWTC.

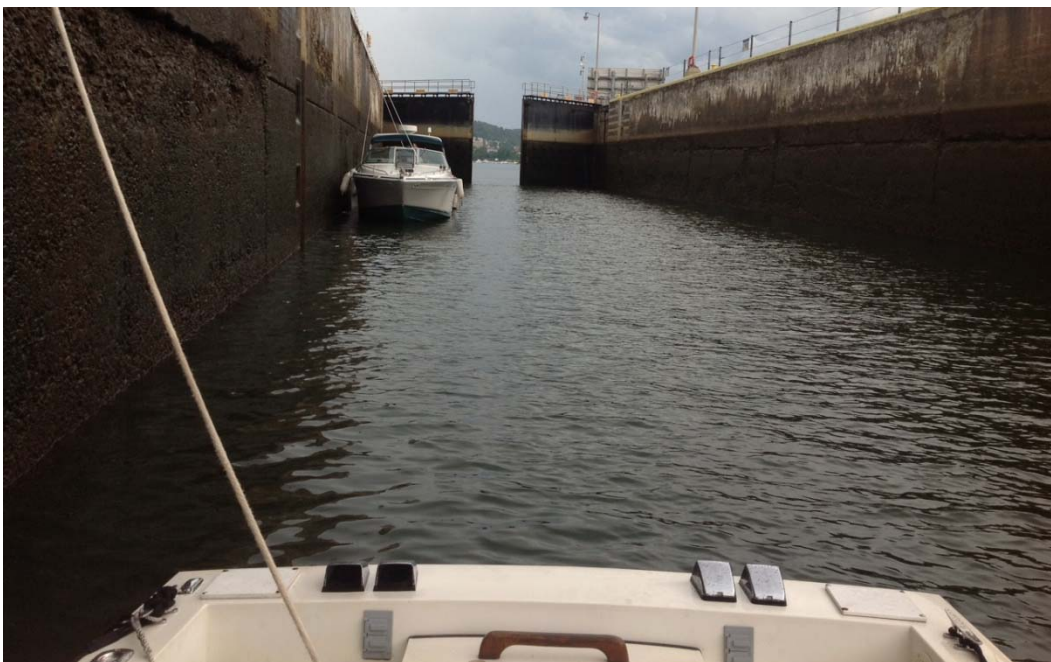
In preparation of the map preparation, we will evaluate state map standards as well as other highly regarded trail map exhibits such as the 10,000 Island Water Trail in the Everglades National Park.

Deliverables: Base map with inset maps and index maps completed in GIS including major and minor roads, hydrology, municipal boundaries, public lands, existing and proposed trails, elevation, access points and river miles. Final layers will be determined by ORTC.

2. Base Map Revisions (Scope: 2.2.4)

One revision of the base map, inset maps and index maps will be completed based on feedback from ORTC and ORWTC.

Deliverables: Revised maps.



C. Preparation of the Water Trail Map and Guide

1. Preparation of Water Trail Map and Guide (Scope: 2.3.1 to 2.3.3)

The critical focus point of this effort is the final map and trail guide, consisting of text and maps. Based on the vision and goals for the final product, the map and guide will synthesize all information and input to create a product that will guide users safely on their paddlesport, motorboat, angling and birding excursions. Because our GIS database is extensive, our Team will have more time to devote to refining and balancing the final content and look of the trail map and guide to ensure its effectiveness and usefulness.

Maps will be exported for the creation of the trail map and guide. Our Team will design and lay out the text and map of the water trail map and guide to maximize visual communication and ease of use. The design of the map and guide will be based on the project statement and goals as well as the previously completed assessment of ORTC maps and trail guides as well as publications from other organizations like the PA Fish and Boat Commission.

Our Team will also create a water trail logo based on the project statement, goals and discussions with ORTC and ORWTC.

We will revise the products based on feedback from ORTC and ORWTC.

Deliverables: Water trail map and guide with up to three major revised versions; water trail logo with up to three major revisions.



Phillis and Georgetown Islands, part of the Ohio River Islands National Wildlife Refuge, will be mapped as part of this project.

2. Digital Files and Publications (Scope: 2.3.3 to 2.3.5)

Based on the preferred final layout and design, our Team will provide all final products in digital format for both online publication and printing. We understand that ORTC may want to incorporate interactive features when publishing the water trail map and guide online. Our products will be prepared to support online interactivity without reworking and/or cost. Our team will work with ORTC to ensure that the map and guide is correctly printed with the correct specifications for a high quality product.

Deliverables: Water trail logo in vector and JPG format; water trail map and guide in 8.5x11 printable Adobe PDF format; press-ready water trail map and guide in EPS or other format for professional printing.

3. Participation

EPD will meeting with ORTC Staff and the ORWC Committee a total of five times to review drafts and feedback. EPD will attend one public meeting.

D. Reimbursable Expenses

All reimbursable expenses have been incorporated into the fee estimate and include travel costs, prints, plots and in-house photocopies as well as hard copies of the map and guide for review. The draft and final products will be delivered in PDF, JPG, EPS and GIS format as applicable to allow for additional duplication and updates as needed.

E. Optional: Publication of Map and Guide

1. Printing and Publication (Scope: 2.4.1 to 2.4.2.7)

If ORTC prefers, our Team can facilitate and complete the final publication and printing of the water trail map and guide.

Deliverables: Press-ready digital file; one set of digital proofs; 10,000 or 20,000 (as determined by ORTC based on option chosen) copies of the final water trail map and guide with the following specifications: 16.50" x 21.75" house gloss 100#T-White (.0055) paper, 4/4:-4/C process over 4/C process ink, cut, fold, shrink-wrap and carton pack.

Months

Nov Dec Jan Feb March April

A. Compile and Review Existing Information

A

1. Compile Existing Information [w1]
2. Review Relevant Plans and Studies [w1]
3. Create Project Statement [w2]
4. Additional Info and Base Maps [w1-2]
5. Field Reconnaissance [w2]

B. Prepare Base Maps

B

1. Prepare Base, Inset and Index Maps [w1]
Meeting 1 [w1]
Committee/Staff Review [w2-3]
2. Revise Maps (includes new information from site check) [w3-4]

C. Preparation of Water Trail Map and Guide

C

1. Prepare First Draft of Map and Guide [w3-4]
Meeting 2 [w4]
Committee Staff Review [w4]-[w2]
Meeting 3 [w3]
2. Revise Map and Guide [w2-4]-[w1]
Meeting 4 [w2]
Committee/Staff Review [w2-4]
Meeting 5 [w4]
3. Revise Map and Guide [w1-3]
Public Meeting: Feb/March [w4] or [w1]
4. Final Document Ready for Printing [w3]

* printing and publication of the map and guide will occur based on ORTC preference

*[w#] indicates anticipated week during the month

*w1 refers to the first full week in each month

Cost Estimate

		Principal				Associate		Designer		Tech		Subtotal		Designer		Subtotal	
Hourly rate		\$135	\$95	\$60	\$60							\$105					
		EPD, LLC					Graphic Desg.							Total			
A	Compile and Review Existing Information and Maps																
	1 Existing Information				16	\$960											\$960
	2 Review Relevant Plans and Studies			3		\$180											\$180
	3 Project Statement		1	1		\$155											\$155
	4 New /Additional Data				16	\$960											\$960
	5 Field Reconnaissance (2 days on site)	16			7	\$2,580											\$2,580
B	Prepare Base Maps for the Map/Guide																
	1 Draft Maps for the Map and Guide				6	\$360											\$360
	2 Map Revisions (total of 1 revision)				6	\$360											\$360
C	Preparation of Water Trail map and Guide																
	1 Draft Logo, Map and Guide (total of 1)	1	1	15	3	\$1,310	3	\$315									\$1,625
	2 Revise Logo, Map and Guide (total of 2)	3	3	26		\$2,250	5	\$525									\$2,775
	3 Staff/Committee Meetings (@ 3 hours each; 5 total)	6	9			\$1,665											\$1,665
	4 Public Meeting (@ 2 hours; 1 total)		2	2		\$310											\$310
D	Reimbursable Expenses*					\$1,100											
	Total Without Publication of Map and Guide	26	16	47	54	\$12,190	8	\$840									\$13,030
E	Publication of Map and Guide																
	1 Printing Costs @ 10,000 Copies																\$2,438
	2 Printing Costs @ 20,000 Copies																\$3,778

*Reimbursable Expenses include \$650 for boat rental, fuel and other operational expenses related to field reconnaissance

*No time costs will be applied during the return trip from the southern portion of the corridor to the home marina in Pittsburgh

The fee for professional services as described in this proposal is to be charged on a time including reimbursable basis.

1. EPD Principal's time will be billed at \$135.00 per hour.
2. EPD Associate's time will be billed at \$95.00 per hour.
3. EPD Landscape Designer's time will be billed at \$60.00 per hour.
4. EPD GIS/CAD Technician's time will be billed at \$60.00 per hour.
5. blue tomato Design, Principal's time will be billed at \$105.00 per hour.
6. Stenographic services, normal drafting supplies and other incidental costs are covered by the fees noted above. Printing, photographic reproduction, photocopying, mailings, travel expenses, long distance telephone calls, renderings and any other non-incidental expenses are reimbursable at cost.
7. Invoices will be submitted monthly; payments are due 30 days from date of invoice. Any overdue payments are subject to interest charges of 1.5% per month charged from the 30th day forward.
8. If the services as described in the Scope of Work are not completed within twelve months of signing this Agreement, the rates for EPD's Principal and Associate shall be increased annually by the change in the Consumer Price Index for the previous twelve (12) months. This increase shall not effective the total budget of the project.

We can begin work upon the signing of this proposal. Any work tasks in addition to those listed under Scope of Work will be provided on a time basis as authorized by the Ohio River Trail Council

ADDITIONAL SERVICES

Additional Services shall be provided if authorized or confirmed by the Owner and they shall be paid for by the Owner as provided in this Agreement.

SCHEDULE

All services outlined shall be completed as directed and within a mutually acceptable time frame.

MAPPING / PLANNING / SURVEY DATA

It is understood that all necessary information (i.e. base mapping, planning data, survey information, engineering data and architectural drawings, including an accurate legal description of the property) requested will be supplied in digital format if available by the Ohio River Trail Council.

DIGITAL FILES

At the Ohio River Trail Council's request, the Consulting Firm shall provide electronic data files in a format compatible to the municipality (Microsoft® Office 2010, Adobe® Photoshop, ArcMap® 10.1). The Consulting Firm makes no representation as to the compatibility of these files with the Ohio River Trail Council's hardware or software.

LIABILITY

The Ohio River Trail Council and the Consulting Firm have discussed the risks, rewards and benefits of the project and the Consulting Firm's total fee for services. The risks have been allocated such that the Ohio River Trail Council agrees that to the fullest extent permitted by law, the Consulting Firm's total liability to Ohio River Trail Council for any and all injuries, claims, losses, expenses, damages or claims expenses arising out of this Agreement from any cause or causes, will not exceed the total amount of \$100,000. Such causes include but are not limited to the Consulting Firm's negligence, errors, omissions, strict liability, breach of contract or breach of warranty.

OWNERSHIP OF DOCUMENTS

The Ohio River Trail Council acknowledges the Consulting Firm's plans, reports, specifications, or other documents as instruments of professional service and is not deemed a sale. Nevertheless, the instruments of service prepared under this Agreement will become the property of the Ohio River Trail Council upon completion of the work and final payment. The Ohio River Trail Council agrees, to the fullest extent permitted by law, arising out of any changes made by anyone other than the Consulting Firm or from any transfer reuse or modification of the instruments of service without the prior written authorization of Environmental Planning and Design, LLC.

COPYRIGHT OWNERSHIP

All works (including instruments of service) produced by the Consulting Firm and its staff under this Agreement shall be deemed works made for hire under federal copyright law and all rights to these works shall vest in the Ohio River Trail Council.

TERMINATION

It is understood that either party will have the right to terminate this Agreement at any time upon thirty (30) days written notification and upon the condition that full payment in accordance with the above stated compensation schedule is made to Environmental Planning and Design, LLC for services performed to the date of termination.

Environmental Planning and Design, LLC (formerly Simonds and Simonds) was established in 1939 to provide public and private clients landscape architectural, urban design and community planning services. Our 74 years of experience has allowed us to develop a nationally acclaimed practice and an enduring legacy. The present organization, its fourth generation of ownership, includes Jack R. Scholl, Andrew JG Schwartz, and Susan M. Simmers as Principals.

Expertise

EPD holds registrations and certifications in the fields of Landscape Architecture, Urban Design and Community Planning. The firm's diversity allows us to deal with a multitude of issues, ranging in scale and complexity. Our professional expertise permits us to focus our abilities on specific planning and design activities as well as sustainability approaches.

Philosophy

As the basis of our project philosophy, we utilize an iterative design process to blend our skills in stewardship, analysis, and conceptualization. We continuously evaluate a project's strategic implications and refine its attributes to optimize the design solution. Through this iterative process, we are able to fuse the principles of sustainable planning and green design with the reality of economic needs, design practicality and community values. The appropriate level of client and/or public involvement in the planning and design process is imperative for success. Our firm has developed and extensively used participation techniques to establish "consensus" in our projects. The integration of these approaches provides the foundation for creating timeless planning and design solutions and successful project implementation. We have become renowned in the planning and design community for creativity, functionality, practicality, sustainability and quality.

Statement of Values

Our firm's statement of values enables us to enjoy and take pride in everything that we do. These values guide us in carrying on the strong legacy of our firm.

Provide unrivaled service

- Client-centered focus
- Direct principal involvement
- On time, under budget

Develop sustainable, timeless design

- Unmatchable creativity
- Enduring quality
- Resolute resource sensitivity

Encourage staff development

- Right people, right passion
- Highly accountable team
- Innovative, imaginative expert



*Environmental Planning & Design's office
featuring the sculpture "Mother Earth"*

EPD has created logos for a number of projects, some before the project started and some at the direction of the client. Each logo represents a unique perspective on the client's goals and the project's direction.



positivelyALTOONA



GTN|law



Client:

- Municipal governments and entities
- Nonprofit organizations
- Private sector clients

Services:

- Analyze the project vision and goals
- Create visual logos to brand projects
- Provide files in JPG, EPS or other format to allow for maximum usability

Purpose:

- To create logos that can be used throughout a project and beyond for marketing and branding

Key Elements:

- Logos tailored to each project
- Incorporate client's chosen colors and symbols or create a new palette

Client:

- Aspinwall Riverfront Park, Inc.

Services:

- Master Planning
- Sustainable Design
- Cost Estimation
- Public Engagement

Sub-Consultants:

- NIPpaysage
- Studio d'ARC architects, P.C.
- Lennon, Smith, Souleret Engineering, Inc.
- Zanetta Illustration

Purpose:

- To design a Master Plan for a new 13-acre Park in the midst of a working waterfront; including provisions for the future development of the Pittsburgh to Erie Trail through the site.

Key Elements:

- Maintenance and incorporation of the existing private marina whose revenues will help offset Park maintenance costs.
- Installation of a barge to provide water access and a public “beach”.

Other Information:

- Construction Start - N/A
- Construction Completion - N/A
- Construction Cost - N/A

Situated along the Allegheny River, the development of the nearly 14-acre Aspinwall Riverfront Community Park (ARC Park) has provided the community with public access to its riverfront, something the community has not had for more than 100-years. The Park is located on a working waterfront that includes private marinas, a federal lock and dam facility, a water treatment facility and a metal scrap yard. The Master Plan leverages this working waterfront to create a fiscally sustainable development model by maintaining an existing private marina on-site. In addition to capitalizing on some shared amenities, revenues from the marina operations will directly fund maintenance costs for the park. ARC Park design concept, “Raindrops to River”, furthers the principal of sustainable development through the implementation of passive storm water management best practices and the reclamation/restoration of a naturalized river edge.

Finally, ARC Park serves as a an important link in the proposed Pittsburgh to Erie Trail, and accommodates this future connection/development, as well as providing over a mile of internal trails through man-made wetlands and a successional landscape. Other key features include a one-of-a-kind barge with water access and a public “beach”, a playground, public art and landscape sculpture, etc.



Emerald View Park Trail Plan Allegheny County, Pennsylvania

EPD prepared the Trail Master Plan for Emerald View Park, a 235 acre greenway which extends along the wooded hillsides of the City of Pittsburgh's Mt. Washington neighborhood. The greenway includes neighborhood parks, several miles of trails, and a scenic pedestrian promenade with internationally renowned views of downtown Pittsburgh.

EPD worked with a neighborhood group to develop a plan for approximately 19-miles of multi-use trails. A series of existing trails were evaluated to determine which sections should remain, be enhanced, be relocated or removed. Ten miles of new trails were blazed to create a comprehensive trail network. The Plan forms connections to historical/cultural/neighborhood amenities as well as to other regional trail systems including the Great Allegheny Passage. Each year the community continues to improve the trail, with over 2 miles of trail constructed so far.

The plan EPD developed for the trail has been used to publicize and raise awareness of Emerald View Park since before construction was started.

Client:

- Mount Washington Community Development Corporation

Services:

- Trail Master Planning
- Best Management Consulting
- Implementation/Action Planning
- Cost Estimating
- Public Engagement
- Construction Training and Oversight

Purposes:

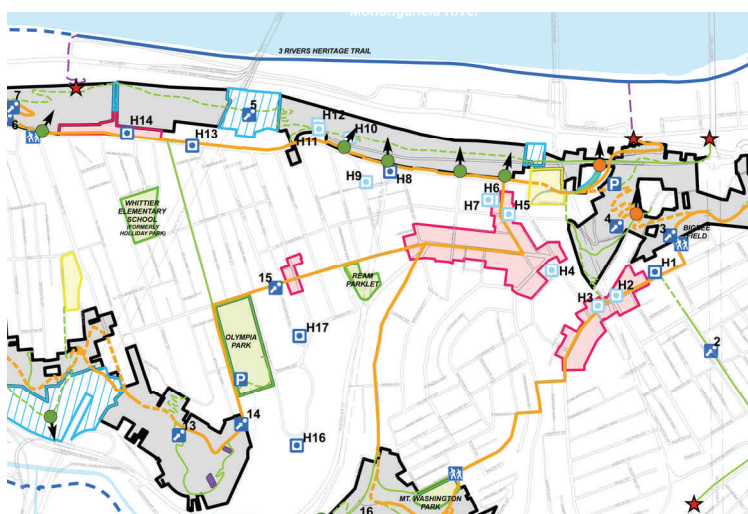
- To prepare a Master Plan for the development of a comprehensive urban wilderness trail system for the Emerald View Park.

Key Elements:

- Wilderness trails in an urban area, wayfinding signage, connections to local neighborhood business districts as well as other regional trail systems.
- Conduct trail flagging, construction training and oversight.

Other Information:

- Construction Start—2011
- Construction Completion -
-Phase I—2011
-Phase II 2012
- Construction Cost - Nominal



"A jewel of a trail, helps outdoor lovers be high over the city." Pittsburgh Post Gazette

Client:

- City of Pittsburgh, Department of City of Planning

Services:

- Land Use Analysis
- Natural Resource Assessment
- Master Planning
- Strategic Planning
- Public Involvement

Purpose:

- To identify the best use of the City's Riverfront environment and to establish and development policy framework to guide public and private-sector investments.

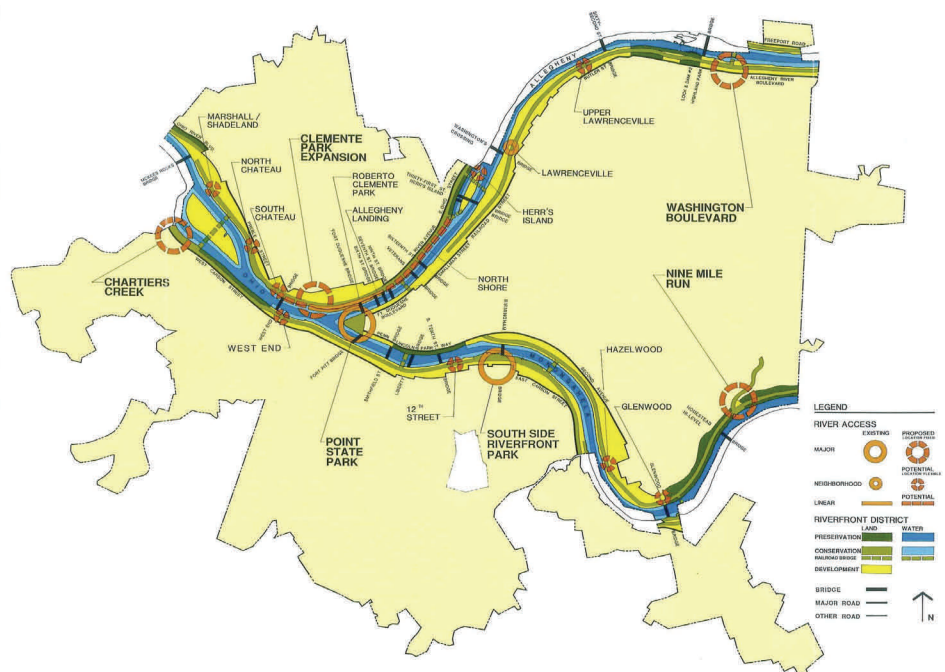
Key Elements:

- A credo for riverfront access and development
- Delineation of preservation, conservation and development zones designed to protect riverbanks and accommodate public access
- An outline of development standards
- A coordinated approval process that eliminates ad-hoc and non-sequential approvals for proposed developments situated within the riverfront zone

The strategy to enhance and utilize Pittsburgh's Riverfronts, a Comprehensive Plan for the City's 35-mile waterfront corridor, was authored by EPD with integrated input from the City's Department of City Planning. The Plan for the Pittsburgh Riverfronts is a comprehensive framework through which decisions can be made regarding the expansion of the City's waterfront.

The City's waterways are much like public streets and development must be carefully guided to achieve a balance of public, private, aesthetic and environmental goals. This Plan strives to promote a diverse waterfront by integrating environmental concerns, private riverfront development and public river access.

The Plan for the Pittsburgh Riverfronts has been adopted by the City of Pittsburgh. The Plan is used to promote economic growth, enrich the City's quality of life, protect water resources and provide consistency for waterfront development.



The Beaver River watershed, covering 58,000 acres of primarily rural land, has experienced several severe floods over the past fifteen (15) years. This led the Pennsylvania Environmental Council along with Environmental Planning and Design, LLC to perform a comprehensive review and analysis of land use and conservation in this 22-mile long watershed. The Plan is innovative in its approach with the study area encompassing each of the river's 17 tributaries and its entire watershed area.

EPD's role in the project was two-fold: first, to perform field assessments and GIS analyses of the area's ecology, storm drainage, flood plain management, culture and heritage, land use, utilities, and transportation improvements.. Second, using these analyses to develop a set of recommended policies related to the watershed's land use, zoning and development.

Client:

- Pennsylvania Environmental Council

Services:

- GIS Mapping and Analyses
- Natural Resource Assessment
- Land Use Planning
- Flood Modeling

Consultants:

- Rettew Associates, Inc.

Purpose:

- To develop a series of watershed management and land use tools based on close analysis of the conditions of natural and physical elements of the region.

Key Elements:

- Field reconnaissance and GIS analysis of natural and physical features of the watershed.
- Preparation of a prioritized Action List to address future conservation and development opportunities.



Client:

- North Central Pennsylvania Regional Planning and Development Commission

Prime Consultant:

- Johnson, Mirmiran & Thompson

Services:

- Existing Conditions/Structures Analysis
- Needs and programming Assessment
- Trail Master Planning
- Construction Cost Estimation

Purpose:

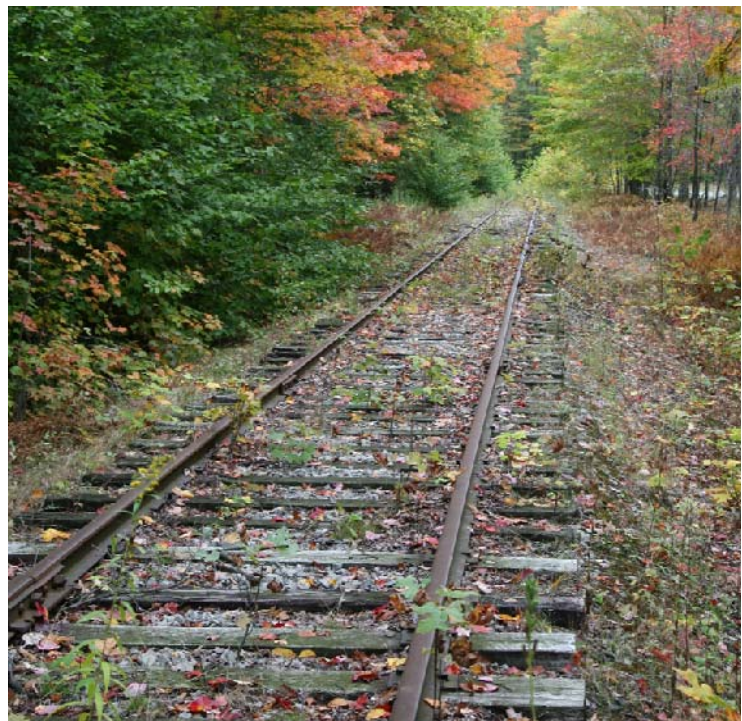
- To prepare a Rail Trail Feasibility Master Plan for nearly 70 miles of the former Knox Kane Railroad Corridor.

Key Elements:

- Evaluation of potential trail connections to adjacent amenities such as schools, downtowns, parks, historic/cultural destination, etc.
- Explore the potential for re-use of the corridor for scenic railroad tours.

The Planning Team of Johnson, Mirmiran & Thompson and Environmental Planning and Design, LLC was retained to develop a Rail Trail Feasibility Study for the Knox Kane rail corridor from Kinzua Bridge State Park to Knox, PA, nearly 70 miles. A detailed assessment of existing and potential trail demand/use was conducted identifying key trail user groups and necessary programming. In addition, the Team explored the potential re-use of the rail line for scenic tours which have proven successful elsewhere.

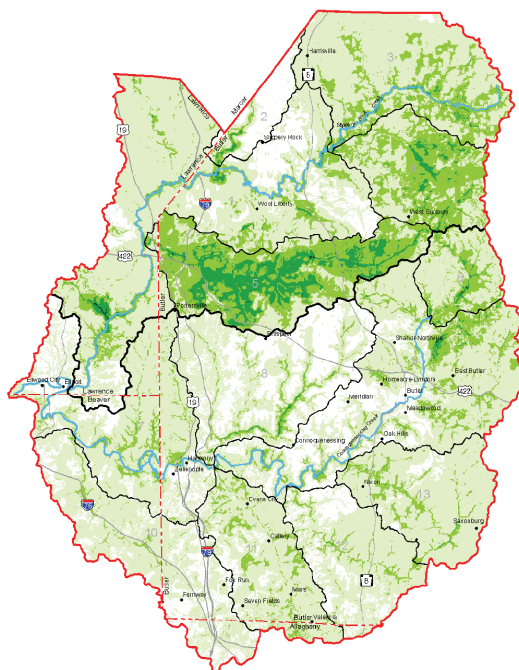
The Trail Master Plan that identifies specific trail improvements, trail connections to adjacent municipalities and amenities, as well as a phasing plan with estimated improvement cost by phase.



Slippery Rock/Connoquenessing Creek Greenprint Analysis and Conservation Strategy Southwestern, Pennsylvania

Stemming from the analyses and findings of the nine-county Southwestern Pennsylvania Natural Infrastructure project, the Pennsylvania Environmental Council engaged Environmental Planning & Design, LLC to create a Greenprint Analysis and Conservation Strategy focused on identifying and prioritizing natural areas to be protected, purchased or restored for conservation and scenic enjoyment.

This multi-jurisdictional study encompassed portions of four counties that make up the Slippery Rock/Connoquenessing Creek watersheds



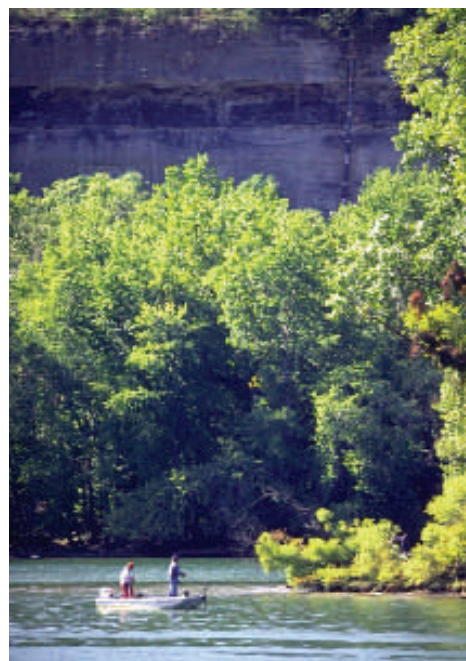
Allegheny County Riverfront Policies Plan Allegheny County, Pennsylvania

Allegheny County's four major rivers – the Ohio, Monongahela, Allegheny and Youghiogheny– have undergone substantial change over the past fifty years. A century of industrial activity has given way to a host of redevelopment and conservation possibilities. In response, the Allegheny County Department of Economic Development commissioned Environmental Planning and Design, LLC to prepare a comprehensive Riverfront Policies Plan for the riverfronts.

Creation of the Plan included the compilation of over 50 distinct sets of data and information, including numerous maps, air photos, planning documents and engineering studies. These data sources were analyzed, shared with the County and refined into a three-part report and flyer.

The three parts of the plan were:

- A Riverfront Development and Access Plan
- A County Riverfront Policy
- An Implementation Action Plan

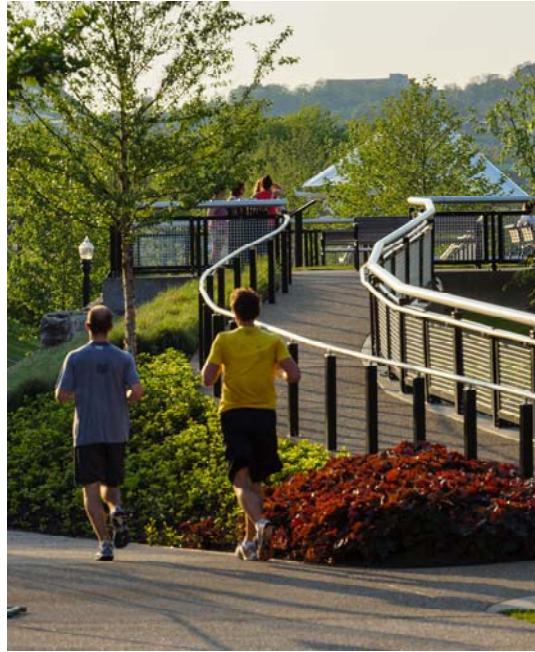


Other Related Project Summaries

South Shore Riverfront Park Master Plan Allegheny County, Pennsylvania

Environmental Planning and Design, LLC (EPD), leading a multi-disciplinary consultant team, designed the South Shore Riverfront Master Plan. The Riverfront Master Plan adjoins the Monongahela River and the South Side Works development, a 130-acre brownfield site with over 1.3 million square feet of mixed use development. The Park Master Plan provides South Side residents with a major public venue and enhances the riverfront identity of the South Side.

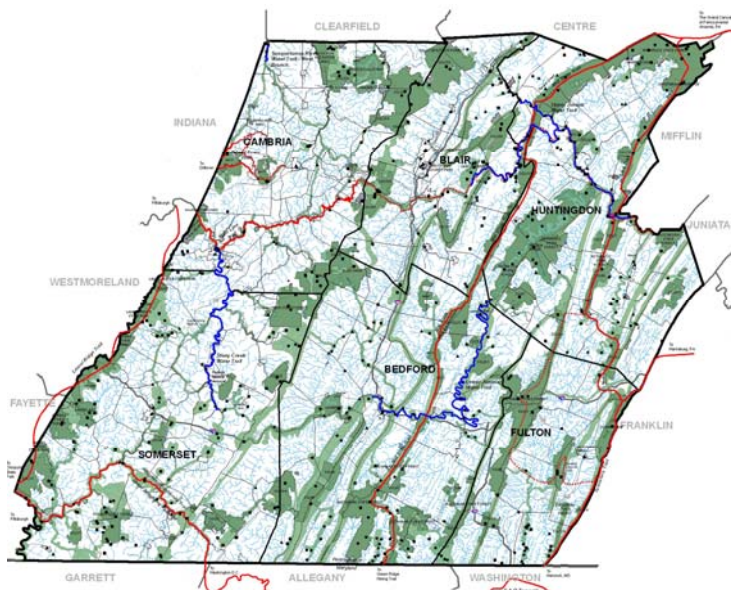
These public spaces provide destinations for pedestrians and cyclists and offer unique vistas of the Downtown Pittsburgh skyline and the river. Despite more than 35 vertical feet of grading changes, all proposed circulation routes and amenities have been designed to be universally accessible and form an important part of the Three Rivers Heritage Trail system and the Great Allegheny Passage.



Southern Alleghenies Greenway Plan Allegheny County, Pennsylvania

Working with a Greenways Committee composed of County Planning Directors, DCNR officials and representatives of Southern Alleghenies Planning and Development Commission (SAP&DC) EPD prepared a six-county regional greenways plan and implementation toolbox. In addition to the Greenways Committee involvement, the Planning Team facilitated a multi-layered participation process that included key stakeholders, focus study and several public sessions scheduled at strategic points in time to guide the development of the individual county plans as well as the integrated regional plan.

Work tasks included compiling existing GIS and demographic data for each county to create a series of maps.



Emerald View Park Trail Plan

Ms. Ilyssa Manspeizer, Ph.D, Park Resource Manager
Mount Washington Community Development Corporation
301 Shiloh Street
Pittsburgh, PA 15211
412-481-3220

Beaver River Conservation and Management Plan

Power of 32 Trails

Mr. Davitt Woodwell, Vice President
Pennsylvania Environmental Council
22 Terminal Way
Pittsburgh, PA 15219
(412) 481-9400

Aspinwall Riverfront Community Park Master Plan

Ms. Susan Crookston
Aspinwall Riverfront Park, Inc.
285 River Avenue
Aspinwall, PA 15215
412-298-1196 or 412-781-6455

**Andrew JG Schwartz, RLA, AICP, LEED®AP,
Principal-In-Charge, Managing Principal**

EP&D | Environmental
Planning & Design, LLC

Professional Experience:

1989 - present
Environmental Planning & Design, LLC

Education:

Penn State University
-Bachelors in Landscape Architecture
University of Michigan
-Masters in Urban and Regional Planning

Registrations:

American Institute of Certified Planners
Registered Landscape Architect PA and OH
LEED® AP

Professional Memberships:

The American Society of Landscape
Architects
American Planning Association
The Urban Land Institute
Pennsylvania Recreation and Parks Society

Other Information:

Member of Pittsburgh Trails Advisory
Group
Invited Consultant at the 2012 ThinkBike
Workshop
Former member of the City of Pittsburgh
Contextual Design Advisory Panel
Lifetime Member PA Parks and Recreation
Society

Speaking Engagements:

-2012 Shippensburg University Symposium
on Designing Healthy Communities
-2012 American Planning Association—PA
-2011 American Planning Association— PA
-2010 Pennsylvania Planning Association
-2010 NARRP Conference
-2007 Pennsylvania Land Conservation
-2006 ESRI International GIS
User Conference
-2006 Pennsylvania Greenway Conference
-2006 Western Pennsylvania Trails
Symposium
-2003 and 2005 PA GIS Conferences

Key Related Projects:

- Emerald View Park Trail Plan
- South Shore Riverfront Park Master
Plan
- Knox Kane Rail Trail Feasibility Study
- Beaver River Conservation and
Management Plan



Andrew (AJ) Schwartz has worked extensively on natural resource assessments, comprehensive recreation plans, river conservation and recreation plans, park and trail master plans, recreation feasibility studies and strategic plans for recreation-oriented projects. From this project diversity, he has developed special skills in environmental assessment, program conceptualization, resource optimization and plan implementation, and most importantly, effective plan communication.

With that, he has been able to work on a number of water-oriented projects identifying connections between recreation, safety, economic development and effectiveness/styles of information communication. *These projects, along with recreation pursuits, have enabled AJ to navigate his kayak in places such as Lake Erie, Lake Ontario, Lake Michigan, Detroit River, the Outer Banks/ Atlantic Ocean, the Florida Everglades, Hawaii, Alaska, New York Finger Lakes, Potomac River (Paddle Marathon), Severn River, Chesapeake Bay, Monongahela River, Allegheny River, Ohio River and the Allegheny Reservoir.*

Through all of these experiences, Mr. Schwartz's has become well regarded with professional recreation practitioners and clients as an effective project manager and project communicator.

Carolyn E. Yagle, AICP, RLA
Associate



Launching her kayak in Pittsburgh almost 15 years ago, Carolyn is a seasoned paddler of the region's Three Rivers, their tributaries as well as many other bodies of flowing and still water throughout North America and Canada. As part of preparing the Ohio River Trail Council's Water Trail Map and Guide Map, Carolyn will wear two hats to offer practical knowledge to mapping review: as general water recreation enthusiast and a policy planner for riverfront communities. Through these initiatives, Carolyn understands the intricacies and enthusiasm of turning concepts like these into reality.

In addition to paddling, Carolyn has traveled the Ohio River from Pittsburgh to Cincinnati and back via motor boat. Navigating this stretch exposed both the complexities and fun of personal interaction with the water as well as how development and policy decisions can influence river-oriented economics.

In applying professional and personal experience of this Corridor to this effort, Carolyn will serve as the key Team member responsible for design, legibility and quality assurance/review.

**EP&D | Environmental
Planning & Design, LLC**

Professional Experience:

1997 - present
Environmental Planning & Design, LLC

1996 - US Department of Agriculture
Natural Resource and Conservation
Service Internship (WV)

1995 - Universidad de Guanajuato
Guanajuato, Mexico
Architecture Exchange

Awards:

West Virginia University's Order of
Augusta: Highest award given for
scholarship, leadership and service

Education:

West Virginia University, Summa Cum
Laude

- BS in Landscape Architecture
- University Honors Program
- Honor Society of Agriculture
- Gamma Sigma Delta

Registrations:

Registered Landscape Architect in PA
American Institute of Certified Planners

Professional Memberships:

American Society of Landscape Architects
American Planning Association

Key Related Projects:

- Beaver River Conservation Strategy
- Sewickley Valley Impact Analyses
- Sewickley-Aleppo-Glen Osborne Comprehensive Plan
- Avalon-Bellevue-Ben Avon Comprehensive Plan
- Neville Riverfront Plan
- Moon Township Comp. Plan (2000)
- Participant and presenter in the 2004 Allegheny County River Dialogue: Watertrails series (CMU)

Other Relevant Information/

Involvement:

Current Member of the City of Pittsburgh
Contextual Design Advisory Panel

Current Green Ribbon Committee Member
for City of PGH's Comprehensive Parks,
Recreation and Open Space Initiative

Invited Consultant 2012 City of PGH
ThinkBike Workshop

John Douglass

John Douglass is the GIS Division leader at EPD and has 20 years of experience. His extensive experience in GIS projects spans numerous corridor studies, comprehensive plans, greenway plans, master site plans, and natural infrastructure plans. His experience includes projects on the municipal, county and regional scale using Microstation, GeoPak, ArcMap, ArcView, ArcGIS, Spatial Analyst, and other GIS/CADD packages. He is the principal creator of EPD's GIS database.

Jennifer Cristobal

Jen is a Planner and Landscape Designer at EPD and has 5 years of practical experience in community planning, urban planning and landscape architecture. She has prepared downtown master plans, feasibility studies and comprehensive plans, analyzing communities and engaging in community outreach to create tailored strategies for individual boroughs, townships and counties. She generates mapping components participates in community engagement and assembles report documents and graphics for final production. Jennifer received her Masters of Landscape Architecture from Chatham University and a BA in Urban Studies from the University of Pittsburgh.

Thomas Cenna, RLA, LEED® AP

Thomas Cenna is a registered Landscape Architect (RLA) and LEED® accredited professional at EPD and has 12 years of experience. Tom has worked on a wide variety of project types including residential, commercial, office, parks and recreation, education, urban design, and destination development. He brings a strong understanding of the development/construction process helping his clients navigate through the permitting process, cost estimating, construction documentation, etc. He also maintains a strong knowledge of construction administration through his time working with a local site development contractor. Thomas received his BS in Landscape Architecture from The Pennsylvania State University.

Blue Tomato INTRODUCTION

For the past 9 years, Blue Tomato has developed effective marketing solutions for new and existing businesses. Our dedication to our clients is incomparable. We maintain direct contact with our clients throughout the design and development process making sure a project stays on target. Our goal is simple... deliver the absolute best product and services to our clients and maintain a professional relationship for years to come.

OUR PHILOSOPHY

It's more than just staying current on all of the latest technology; it's more than just managing projects so they run smoothly; it's the difference Blue Tomato can make to the look of your brand and your business.

We are the oxymoron of cost-effective, high-end design. With out of the box thinking, but not out of this world expense, Blue Tomato generates the kind of visual communications companies want to remain top of mind.

What is your business capable of with the right image? Are there any limits to your success with improved recognition? A picture is worth a thousand words, but in business, the right picture can be worth much, much, more.

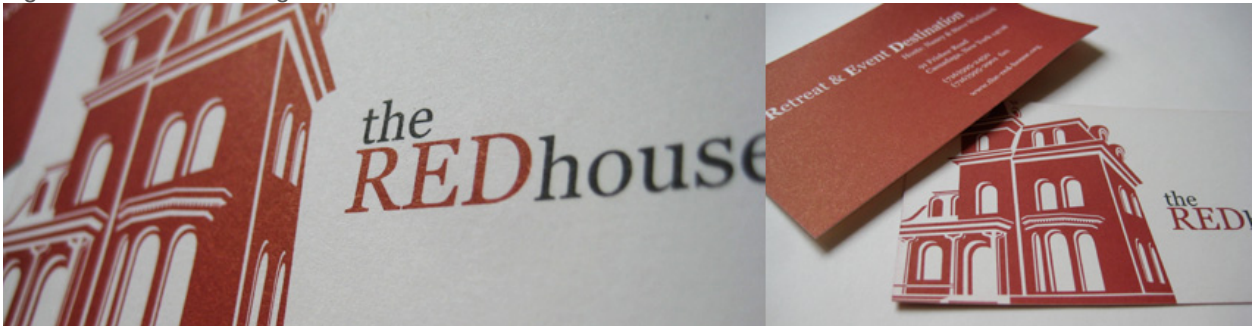


WORK EXAMPLES

please visit our website to view our full portfolio of work www.bluetomatodesign.com

The RED House

The Red House is a non-profit business/special events center located in Cassadaga, New York. Any profits are to the benefit of local youth programs in the area. blue tomato developed the logo and all marketing materials for The RED House.



VCM

VCM is a claims litigation company serving most of the continental United States. blue tomato has worked with VCM for more than 7 years to develop the brand, marketing materials and web presence.





blue tomato®

The Naked Grape

The Naked Grape is a unique Tuscan-style restaurant located in Sewickley, PA. blue tomato worked with the Naked Grape to develop the logo, promotional materials and website.



Davis Davis & Associates

Davis Davis & Associates is a Pittsburgh based-family owned and operated CPA firm. blue tomato work with Davis to create the new logo and company profile brochure.





blue tomato®

South Side Improvement District

Blue Tomato designed the entire communications campaign for the South Side improvement District Efforts. The campaign launched in summer of 2011 to support the grass roots efforts of the volunteer Steering Committee. Logo, website, posters, PPT, buttons.

The website is a custom built php website with a CMS (content management system) on most pages, allowing the client to make updates to news, media, resources and the home page. The website also allows the public to sign the online Support Submission form and write a testimonial that the client can select to be featured on the Vision Page and/or home page Javascript rotation.



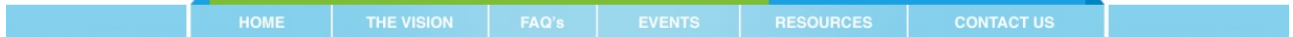


blue tomato®




CLEANSAFEBeautiful

*** {CLEANSAFEBeautiful} ***
ARE YOU IN?
Click below to support the South Side Improvement District and sign the online petition.
[SHOW YOUR SUPPORT](#)



Can You Imagine?

Imagine if East Carson Street were cleaner, safer, and more welcoming. Picture benches that encouraged daytime customers to sit and linger, South Side ambassadors that answered questions and promoted your business, and a clean team that ensured that sidewalks were debris-free. Imagine additional nighttime security to keep customers, staff, and residents safe and happy, positive marketing of the district as a destination for responsible nights out, and programs that help make South Side better for businesses and residents alike.



CLEAN



SAFE



BEAUTIFUL

Interested? [Want to learn more?](#)
[Want to shape the NID plan for South Side?](#)

Call **Susie Puskar** at (412) 481-0651 x 11
or e-mail Susie@southsidepgh.com

[GET INVOLVED](#)

What's Next?

It has been called the "NID", "BID" or "SSID". But find out how it can change your life and the South Side over the next 5 years.

Please join us at the following events to learn more about the Improvement District and what it means for you!

WHEN: September 29, 2011
WHERE: City Theatre
TIME: 5:30pm-7:30pm

WHAT: We want your input and we need you to join us at this discussion to make sure we put together a plan that works for our community!

WHEN: October 15, 2011
WHERE: City Theatre
TIME: 5:30pm-7:30pm

WHAT: It's time to get together to share the final plan before we submit it to City Council. Join us as we review with the community our results from 18 months of community discussions to form a plan that will improve our quality of life in South Side!

ENDORSEMENTS

South Side Planning Forum
South Side Community Council
South Side Chamber of Commerce
South Side Slopes Neighborhood Association
Brashear Association

Have You Seen?

Check out all of the neighbors who support the Improvement District!

*** {CLEANSAFEBeautiful} ***

www.ssimprovementdistrict.com
Proud to Support the South Side Improvement District efforts




like



follow





South Side Tree Project

blue tomato®

The South Side Tree Project was founded by Kim Collins, the owner for Blue Tomato Design in 2009. Seeing a great need to increased green canopy in the South Side neighborhood, The South Side Tree Project works directly with TreeVitalize, TreePittsburgh and the Western Pennsylvania Conservancy and is responsible for almost 200 new trees in the South Side 15203 area.

Blue Tomato created the entire pro-bono campaign to bring awareness to the project and encouraged the neighborhood residents and businesses to participate. Hosting 4 tree plantings and Tree Care Days so far, the Tree Project has become a well known effort in the South Side Community, and will continue to be an asset for years to come.

<http://www.sstreeproject.com>





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Historic South Side Home Tour

Blue Tomato designed the new brand campaign for the Historic South Side Home Tour in exchange for the Blue Tomato logo on all sponsorship promotional materials.





blue tomato®

South Side Chamber of Commerce

Blue Tomato launched the new marketing/membership building campaign for the South Side Chamber of Commerce. A new website, window posters, kiosk design, new membership packets, eblast campaign and event promotions has created new vibrancy throughout the organization. The organization is now set to reach its goal of 100 new members within the next year.

The website features include:

- Featured Members on the home page once per month.
- Events page where members can promote their upcoming events/news.
- Deal Page where members can post an offer or deal/upload a pdf.
- Become a Member Page where interested businesses can download a pdf application.
- The back-end of this website features a CMS and a robust membership database that allows the admin to track membership expiries, auto generate invoices and add new members.
- The Membership Directory is a unique feature that showcases all businesses and highlights Members included top level as

**VISIT
SOUTH SIDE**

visit the new south side destination website
southsidechamber.org



SOUTH SIDE CHAMBER OF COMMERCE

**BUZZ
SOUTH SIDE
BEEHIVE COFFEEHOUSE**

visit the new south side destination website
southsidechamber.org



SOUTH SIDE CHAMBER OF COMMERCE



blue tomato®



SOUTH SIDE CHAMBER OF COMMERCE

CHAMBER
POSTERS

BUZZ
SOUTH SIDE
BEEHIVE COFFEEHOUSE

visit the new south side destination website
southsidechamber.org



SOUTH SIDE CHAMBER OF COMMERCE

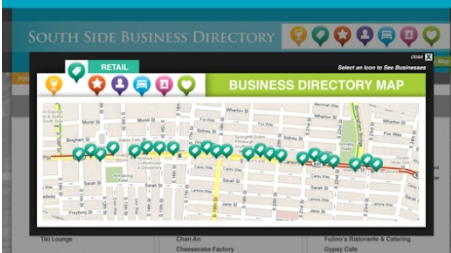
CUSTOM DESIGNED POSTERS

Each Chamber Member receives 1 FREE poster
to hang in your storefront window!

Help support the Chamber and purchase more posters
for only \$5 each!

Call Amy today to order yours! 412-431-3360

Check out the new South Side Chamber website!
www.southsidechamber.org



SOUTH SIDE CHAMBER OF COMMERCE

MEET TED



and his
Excellent Bike Repair Business

visit
southsidechamber.org



WANNA BE FEATURED?

email Amy Murphy at the Chamber office
amy@southsidechamber.org

or call 412-431-3360

southsidechamber.org

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Ben Smith, Artist/CEO
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mmigli@comcast.net
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jrseifarth@comcast.net
412-953-8865

Doreen Valentine, Owner
Dozen Bake Shop
www.dozenbakeshop.com
doreenvalentine@gmail.com
412-491-7853

OUR TEAM



Kim Collins

As the founder and lead artist of **blue tomato**, Kim brings style and experience to clients in need of creative direction. From web design to print, Kim's portfolio boasts a wide range of vibrant work that is known both for its sophisticated creativity and functionality.

Managing a client base that spans all over the country including The Pittsburgh Pirates, Maxime Talbot and MSI WorldWide Mail, Kim's charismatic personality and dedication to projects has allowed her to carry out her dream of owning a design firm that can work as a direct partner with clients.



Taylor Collins

As Senior Developer of our Interactive Development division, Taylor brings an extensive background of web programming and design to blue tomato. His consistency, quality, proficiency and dedication to the team, has allowed **blue tomato** to remain on the cutting edge of the latest technology and standards in the industry.

Taylor strives to maintain the sophistication and professionalism that has become the foundation of **blue tomato**.



Danielle Shearer

blue tomato graphic designer, Danielle brings a youthful flair for design with the maturity showcased in her unique eye for design.

Danielle has worked on projects for our most recent clients including Vallozzi's Restaurant, The Gold Buyers of Pittsburgh, AP Services, College Quest, Imperial Land Corporation & Dozen Bake Shop.